

SOWMYA KURUVELLA

Software Quality Engineering Lead

Orange County, CA | Remote or hybrid | U.S. Citizen

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Quality leader who builds QA functions rather than inherits them: first QA hire at a Class II medical device company, grew it into a 5-person team of direct reports across 4 delivery teams, and owned test strategy, quality gates, and release sign-off for 4 production applications. Architected the automation behind it — 600+ tests running unattended — and authored the verification and validation report for every software release. Nearly 12 years in engineering and quality, 9 in test engineering.

EXPERIENCE

LEAD SOFTWARE TEST ANALYST | InSmile, Irvine, CA | Aug 2025 – Present

Rejoined the product at its 2025 relaunch, after leading QA for the same applications at InBrace. Sole QA engineer. Remote.

- Serve as the company's entire quality function: test strategy, quality gates, release readiness, and go/no-go sign-off across 4 production applications
- Primary QA contact for the platform's migration to new Heroku infrastructure and the company rebrand — revalidated web, API, and integrated systems on the new environment without disrupting release cadence
- Own test execution infrastructure end-to-end: CI on self-hosted AWS EC2 Windows runners with automated lifecycle and start/stop controls that keep cloud spend proportional to actual test usage
- Introduced AI-assisted test development with mandatory review and build-enforced static analysis, raising throughput without lowering the quality bar

InBrace (Swift Health Systems, Inc.), Irvine, CA | Dec 2019 – Apr 2025

LEAD SOFTWARE TEST ANALYST | Dec 2021 – Apr 2025

- Built and led the QA function for a medical device company — patient-specific orthodontic appliances and treatment-planning software; set test strategy and owned the release gate for 4 production applications
- Hired and managed a QA team of 5 direct reports — interviews, onboarding, performance reviews, coaching — and allocated their coverage across 4 delivery teams running parallel release cycles
- Coordinated QA across distributed onshore and offshore teams and external vendor partners in three regions, aligning test scope, handoffs, and defect resolution across time zones
- Directed a hybrid automation framework (Java, Selenium, TestNG, REST Assured, AutoIt) grown to 600+ tests, replacing manual regression with an unattended 1–2 hour run — cutting regression cycle time 40% and post-release defects 25%; extended coverage to the native Windows smile-design application, validating 3D model outputs against reference cases
- Built a Playwright proof of concept in TypeScript to evaluate it against the Selenium framework as a next-generation automation option
- Authored the verification and validation (V&V) release report required for every software release, maintaining design control and traceability; drove root cause analysis on production issues through New Relic, SolarWinds, and database validation
- Led integration and API testing across Salesforce, NetSuite, Expandable ERP, Shopify, Itero, and SmartyStreets, plus AWS, Google Analytics, Dropbox, and Shippo

SOFTWARE TEST ANALYST | Dec 2019 – Dec 2021

- Joined as the company's first QA hire; established automated testing from the ground up, building the first Selenium/TestNG framework with Maven and Bitbucket Pipelines CI
- Executed backend and ETL testing with SQL against Amazon Redshift, PostgreSQL, and SQL Server warehouses; validated Power BI dashboards for data accuracy
- Ran cross-browser and cross-device testing on real devices and LambdaTest across Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android; managed defects in JIRA and test cases in QMetry with full traceability

QA ANALYST | AGADI LLC, Cypress, CA | Apr 2017 – Dec 2019

IT consulting firm; QA automation engagements for enterprise clients

- Built a data-driven Selenium/TestNG automation framework with Maven and Jenkins CI; extended regression coverage to Android with Appium
- Validated SOAP and RESTful services with Postman and backend data with SQL; maintained requirements traceability matrices in TestRail and JIRA

CAREER BREAK — Relocation to the United States | Apr 2008 – Mar 2017

Immigrated from India; obtained work authorization in 2016. Self-study through the break: Microsoft MCTS, .NET Framework 2.0.

.NET PROGRAMMER | CoOptions Technologies Ltd, Hyderabad, India | Sep 2005 – Mar 2008

ERP modules (Financial Accounting, Billing, Inventory, Payroll) in C#, ASP.NET, and SQL Server; unit tests in NUnit.

SKILLS

Leadership: Test strategy and estimation, risk-based regression scope, quality gates and release sign-off, hiring and performance management, onshore/offshore and vendor coordination, defect triage, root cause analysis, quality metrics

Regulatory: Verification and validation reporting, design controls, IEC 62304, ISO 13485, Class II medical device software, traceability

Automation & tooling: Java, TypeScript, Selenium WebDriver, Playwright (proof of concept), TestNG, REST Assured, Autolt, Appium, Postman, LambdaTest, Selenium Grid, Bitbucket Pipelines, Jenkins, Docker, AWS EC2, PowerShell, Maven, Git, SonarQube, Allure, QMetry, JIRA, TestRail

Data & monitoring: SQL, Amazon Redshift, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Power BI, New Relic, SolarWinds

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electronics and Instrumentation | Bapatla Engineering College, India | 2005